# LoopCasts

Team handbook

LoopCasts BV · Ghent
Internal document. Please do not share outside the team.
Seven chapters, each written by the person who does the job

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 01

# Welcome to LoopCasts

*Internal handbook, chapter 1. Written by Marieke. Last updated: somewhere in spring, I think.*

Hi, and welcome to the team!

This handbook explains how we work. Every chapter is written by the person who does that job, so the style changes a bit. If something is unclear, just ask. If something is wrong, it probably changed and nobody updated the handbook. Sorry in advance.

## Who we are

LoopCasts BV makes video trainings about automation. n8n, APIs, webhooks, shell scripting, AI agents: if it saves people from boring work, we make a course about it. Our customers are mostly developers, data people and small agencies. We are based in Ghent, above a bike shop.

I started LoopCasts in 2019 after years of freelance work. In the beginning it was me, a microphone and five orders a week. Today we have about **1,400 paying customers**, **60 courses** and we publish **two new videos every week**. We get about **35 orders a week**, a bit more in January and September.

We are proud that we are still small and that every customer gets an answer from a real person.

## The team

| Who | What | In the office |
|---|---|---|
| **Marieke De Smet** | Founder. Records most courses. Does the invoicing and the money. | Every day, Friday is admin day |
| **Tom Verhaeghe** | The website. | Tuesday and Thursday |
| **Yasmine El Amrani** | Marketing, newsletter, social media, thumbnails. | Mon–Thu |
| **Pieter Claes** | Video editing, uploading, the course catalogue. | Every day |
| **Lotte Janssens** | Orders, customer accounts, support, renewals. | Every day, not Wednesday afternoon |

We also had an intern in 2019, Jens, who built the members area of the website. He was very good. He works in Antwerp now.

## What we sell

All prices without VAT.

| Product | Price | Remarks |
|---|---|---|
| Monthly subscription | € 15 per month | Access to everything. We invoice every month. |
| Yearly subscription | € 149 per year | Most popular. |
| Team licence | € 599 per year | 5 seats. The customer mails us the names. |
| Single course | € 39 | Lifetime access to one course. |
| Company workshop | on quote | Marieke goes on site, 4 to 6 times a year. Every quote is different. |

About VAT: Belgian customers pay 21%. Private persons in other EU countries also 21% (our accountant says this is fine for now). Companies in other EU countries with a VAT number pay 0%, and "VAT reverse charged" must be on the invoice. Outside the EU 0%. When in doubt, ask Marieke.

## The tools we use

- **Outlook** for mail. We have `info@`, `orders@`, `support@` and our personal addresses.
- **Dropbox** for all shared files. The folder structure grew organically. The important files are in `ADMIN`, `ADMIN (new)` and `Marieke old laptop`.
- **Excel and Word** for almost everything in admin.
- **Vimeo** for hosting the videos.
- **FileZilla** to put things on the website.
- **Canva** for thumbnails and social images.
- **The whiteboard** in the kitchen for course ideas. Please do not wipe it.

## A normal week

- **Monday**: team meeting at 10:00. We look at the whiteboard and decide what gets recorded.
- **Tuesday and Thursday**: Tom is in, so website changes happen on those days. If you need something on the site on a Wednesday, it waits until Thursday.
- **Tuesday and Friday**: a new video goes live.
- **Thursday**: newsletter.
- **Friday**: Marieke does invoices, checks payments and makes the backup.

## Where we want to go

We would like to grow to 3,000 customers without hiring three more people for admin. Honestly, we know that some things could be smarter. We teach this stuff! But there is always a video to finish

first. If you see something that can be better, tell us. We mean it.

Marieke

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 02

# The website and hosting

*Internal handbook, chapter 2. Written by Tom. I am only in on Tuesday and Thursday, so read this before you call me.*

## What the website is

`loopcasts.example` is a normal website: HTML, CSS and a little JavaScript. No CMS. I know, I know. In 2019 it was 6 pages and a CMS felt like overkill. Now it is about 140 pages, because every course has its own page and every video has its own page inside the members area.

There are two parts:

1. **The public site**: home, course overview, a page per course, pricing, about, contact.
2. **The members area** ( `/members` ): a PHP script that Jens wrote in 2019. It checks your e-mail and password against a MySQL table and then shows the video pages. It works. Nobody here really understands it. We do not touch it.

## Where the files are

The real website is on the server. My copy is on my laptop in `Documents/loopcasts-site`. Pieter also has a copy because he sometimes fixes typos when I am not in. Yasmine has an older copy for the landing pages.

So the rule is: **before you change anything, download the latest version from the server with FileZilla.** Otherwise you overwrite somebody's work. This happened in March with the pricing page (the old prices were online for four days, a customer noticed).

When I change something big I keep the old file, so you will see things like:

```
index.html
index_old.html
index_final.html
index_final_v3.html
pricing_NEW_use_this_one.html
```

Please do not delete these. I am not sure which ones are still linked.

## How a change goes online

1. Download the latest files from the server (FileZilla, the login is in the passwords file, see chapter 7).
2. Edit the HTML in your editor.
3. Open the file in your browser to check it.

4. Upload the changed files with FileZilla. Do not forget the images.
5. Open the real site and check again. Press Ctrl+F5, the cache is stubborn.

There is no test site. If it is broken, it is broken live, so I try not to do this on Friday afternoon.

## Testing the members area locally

This is a pain. The members area needs PHP and MySQL. I use MAMP with PHP 7.4 because that is what the server had in 2019. Pieter has XAMPP on Windows with PHP 8.2, and there the login page gives warnings. On Yasmine's Mac it does not start at all. The server itself was upgraded by the host last year to PHP 8.1, I think. We found out because the contact form stopped working.

For a new colleague, getting the site to run locally takes me about half a day, if I am in.

## A new course page

When Pieter has a new course, he mails me the title, the description, the list of videos and the Vimeo embed codes. Then I:

1. Copy the page of an existing course and rename it.
2. Replace the title, description, thumbnail and price.
3. Make a page for every video inside `/members` (also copy-paste) and paste the embed code.
4. Add the course to the course overview page **and** to the home page if it is new **and** to the sitemap.
5. Upload everything.

A course with 12 videos takes me about two hours. The list of courses also lives in Pieter's Excel (the catalogue, see chapter 4). The website and the Excel do not always say the same thing. The Excel is supposed to be right.

Twice a week a new video goes live. That is a smaller job: one new page, one link on the course page. About 20 minutes, but it has to happen on Tuesday and Friday, and I am not in on Friday, so I prepare the Friday page on Thursday and Pieter uploads it.

## The order button

On the pricing page, the "Order" buttons are `mailto:` links. They open the customer's mail program with a mail to `orders@` and a subject like "Order: yearly subscription". The customer types their details in the mail. Lotte takes it from there (chapter 3).

We talked about a real order form. It is on the whiteboard.

## Hosting

Shared hosting at a Belgian host, the € 9 a month package. It includes the domain, the mailboxes, FTP, PHP and one MySQL database. Things to know:

- There is a limit of 100 recipients per e-mail (Yasmine knows all about this, chapter 5).
- The host makes backups, but we never tried to restore one.
- The SSL certificate renews by itself now. Until 2022 I did it by hand every year and I forgot once.

## Things I would like, one day

- Not being the only one who can put things online.
- Knowing who changed what, and when.
- A test site.
- Never copy-pasting a video page again.

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 03

# Orders, invoices and payments

*Internal handbook, chapter 3. Written by Lotte (orders, accounts) and Marieke (invoices, payments). Long chapter, sorry. This is where most of the week goes.*

## Part 1 — Orders (Lotte)

### How an order comes in

A customer clicks "Order" on the website. That opens an e-mail to `orders@loopcasts.example`. The customer types what they want and sends it.

What we need: name, e-mail, product, and for companies the company name, address and VAT number. What we get: whatever the customer felt like typing. About one in three orders is missing something, mostly the VAT number or the address, so I mail back and wait. Some people never answer.

Some customers order by replying to the newsletter, or through `info@`, or they call Marieke. Those reach me sooner or later.

### What I do with an order

1. Open `orders 2026.xlsx` in Dropbox (`ADMIN (new)`). If Marieke has it open, I get a "conflicted copy" later and have to merge by hand, so I first ask in the office whether anybody is in the file.
2. Add a row: date, name, e-mail, company, VAT number, country, product, price.
3. Move the mail to the Outlook folder "Orders – to invoice".
4. On Friday Marieke makes the invoices (part 2).
5. When the invoice is paid, Marieke tells me (or colours the row and I notice), and I create the account (part 3).

An order takes me about 5 minutes if it is complete, 15 if I have to mail back. I do this every morning first thing, around 35 a week.

I have an export of the sheet in `samples/orders-2026.csv` if you want to see what it looks like. It is the first two weeks of January, all orders, nothing left out. The colours do not survive an export, so I typed them in a column.

## Part 2 — Invoices (Marieke)

Friday is invoice day. I block the morning.

### Making an invoice

1. Open `Facturen 2026.xlsx` (the invoice register) and scroll to the bottom to find the last invoice number. The format is `2026-0001`, `2026-0002`, and so on. Numbers must be consecutive

without gaps: the accountant is strict about this.

2. Open `invoice template NEW.docx`. Not the one called `invoice template.docx`, that one still has our old address.
3. Type the customer details, the invoice number, the date, the product and the price.
4. Work out the VAT (see chapter 1 for the rules) and type the VAT amount and the total. I use the calculator on my phone.
5. For EU companies: check that there is a VAT number and add the line "VAT reverse charged". I do not check whether the number is valid, I would not know how.
6. Save as Word in `ADMIN (new)/Invoices 2026/` **and** "Save as PDF" in the same folder. File name: invoice number + customer name.
7. Add a row to the invoice register: number, date, customer, amount excl., VAT, total.
8. Mail the PDF to the customer from my own mailbox with our standard text (I have it in a draft and copy it).
9. Go back to the orders sheet and type the invoice number next to the order.

One invoice is about 8 minutes. With 30 to 35 on a Friday, that is my morning, and part of the afternoon in busy weeks.

Monthly subscribers get an invoice every month. There are about 210 of them. I do these on the first Friday of the month, and yes, that is a very long day. I copy last month's Word files and change the number and the date.

### When it goes wrong

- In February Lotte helped with invoicing while I was recording. We both looked up the "last number" at the same moment. Two invoices went out with the same number. The accountant was not happy.
- Sometimes I type 21% on a reverse-charge invoice or the other way around. Customers usually tell us. Then I make a credit note, which is the same process again, twice.
- Once I sent the PDF of customer A to customer B. Same first name.

### Payments

Customers pay by bank transfer. We ask them to put the invoice number in the message. About half do. The others write things like "loopcasts", their own order reference, or nothing.

On Friday afternoon I open the KBC app on my phone and go through the incoming payments of the week next to the invoice register on my laptop. When I find a match, **I colour the row green**. Green = paid. Orange = paid, but the amount was wrong. No colour = not paid yet. Lotte uses red in the orders sheet for "account created", do not mix them up.

Matching is detective work when the message is empty: I compare amounts and names. € 180.29 (yearly, with VAT) is a very common amount, so that does not help much.

This means a customer who pays on Monday waits until Friday evening, sometimes Monday, for their login. We get mails about this every week. For impatient customers I check the app in between, if I think of it.

### Reminders

Once a month, roughly, I scroll through the register looking for rows without a colour that are older than 30 days, and I send those customers a friendly reminder. I write each one by hand because I want to check first whether they maybe did pay and I missed it. There are usually 15 to 20. I do not always get to it. At the moment I think about € 4,000 is open, but I would have to count.

### Numbers for the accountant and for us

- Every quarter I zip all invoice PDFs and mail them to the accountant, together with the register. She retypes them into her system, as far as I know.
- Every month I want to know the revenue. I filter the register on month and add up the green rows. Excel cannot sum by colour (or I do not know how), so I select them by hand and look at the total at the bottom. Pieter once did the same for the same month and got a different number. We never found out why.

The register export is in `samples/invoice-register.csv` (same two weeks of January, plus one correction from the week after; the monthly subscribers are in another tab and not in the export).

### Workshop quotes

Four to six times a year a company asks for a workshop on site. I have a call with them, think about the programme, and write a quote in Word. Every quote is different. This takes me two hours each, and I like doing it.

## Part 3 — Customer accounts (Lotte)

When a row is green, the customer gets access.

1. Log in to phpMyAdmin at the host (login is in the passwords file).
2. Open the table `users` and click "Insert".
3. Fill in e-mail, a password that I make up (I use a pattern: first name + a number), the product and the end date.
4. The members script wants the password as an MD5 hash, so I pick "MD5" in the function dropdown. Jens showed me this. If you forget the dropdown, the login does not work.
5. Mail the customer their login and password with the welcome text (from a draft).
6. Colour the row in the orders sheet red (red = account created; I know it is confusing, I started with red before Marieke started with green).

About 5 minutes per account. For a team licence it is five accounts, and the customer mails the names separately, often weeks later, often one at a time.

When a subscription ends, I should set the account to inactive. See chapter 6 for how that goes in practice.

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 04

# Making a course

*Internal handbook, chapter 4. Written by Pieter, with a bit by Marieke about ideas.*

## From idea to course (Marieke)

Ideas come from everywhere: customer mails, questions under our LinkedIn posts, things I run into myself, new releases of n8n. When somebody has an idea, they write it on **the whiteboard in the kitchen**. On Monday we look at the board and pick.

Before the cleaning company comes (every second Thursday) somebody takes a photo of the whiteboard, just in case. The photos are in the WhatsApp group.

Customers often ask "is there a course about X coming?". Honestly, we mostly do not know whether somebody asked for X before. Lotte sometimes remembers.

Once an idea is picked, I write a script in Word: what I will show, in which order, the example files. The scripts are in Dropbox in `Courses/scripts/`, more or less. Some are still on my old laptop. A script for a 10-minute video takes me about an hour and a half. I would not want to give that away, that is the real work and I enjoy it. Same for the recording itself.

## Recording and editing (Pieter)

Marieke records with OBS. She puts the raw files in Dropbox, in `Courses/RAW/`, and tells me in WhatsApp. Sometimes she forgets to tell me and I find them on Monday.

I edit in DaVinci Resolve: cut the mistakes, add the intro and outro, zoom in where the text is small, normalise the audio. Editing is craft, about two hours per video. Then the boring part starts.

## After the edit: the checklist

For **every video** (two a week, so about 100 a year):

1. Export from DaVinci (20 minutes, I can do something else meanwhile, but I have to remember to come back).
2. Upload to Vimeo through the website. Wait.
3. In Vimeo: type the title, type the description, pick the folder, set privacy to "only embed on loopcasts.example". If I forget the privacy setting the video is public. This happened twice.
4. Watch the video again to write down the **chapters** with timestamps (00:00 Intro, 01:24 The webhook node, ...). Customers love chapters. For a 12-minute video this takes 15 to 20 minutes.
5. Write the **description** for the course page: 3 or 4 sentences about what you learn. I am an editor, not a writer, so this takes me longer than it should.
6. Ask Yasmine for a **thumbnail** (she makes it in Canva from a template, changes the title and the number).

7. Copy the Vimeo embed code and mail it to Tom together with title, description and chapters, so he can make the page (chapter 2).
8. Update the **course catalogue** (see below).
9. Tell Yasmine the video is ready so she can announce it (chapter 5). I usually just shout across the office.

Steps 2 to 9 are about an hour per video when nothing goes wrong.

### Subtitles

We do not have subtitles. We know we should: customers ask for them, about a third of our customers are not native English speakers, and it would be good for accessibility. We once got a quote from a subtitling company: € 1.50 per minute. With our back catalogue of roughly 9,000 minutes we decided to "look at it later".

### Transcripts and search

Customers ask "in which video did Marieke explain the thing with the retry setting?". We do not know either. There is no search in the members area, and we have no text version of what is said in the videos. I usually answer from memory.

## The course catalogue

`course catalogue.xlsx` is the list of all courses: title, level, number of videos, total duration, status (draft, live, retired), publication date, price if sold separately.

I keep it up to date. It is supposed to be the truth. Tom copies from it to the website, Yasmine uses it for the newsletter, Marieke uses it for quotes, Lotte uses it to answer customers.

In practice:

- The total duration I add up by hand from the video lengths. I write it however it comes out: `1h20`, `80 min`, `1:20:00`.
- Sometimes a course is live on the site while my sheet still says draft, because Tom was faster than me. Or the other way around.
- Levels: we agreed on beginner / intermediate / advanced, but older rows have other words.

An export is in `samples/course-catalogue.csv`.

## When a tool changes

Our courses are about software that changes all the time. When n8n renames a node or changes a screen, the old video is wrong. We find out when a customer mails us. There is no list of "which video shows which version of which tool". I would like one, I have no idea how to make it without watching 9,000 minutes again.

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 05

# Marketing and promo

*Internal handbook, chapter 5. Written by Yasmine.*

I do everything that makes people find us: the newsletter, social media, thumbnails, landing pages, the occasional discount action. I work Monday to Thursday.

## The newsletter

Every Thursday. About 6,200 people receive it: customers, ex-customers and people who signed up through the form on the website.

### The list

The list is `newsletter list MASTER.xlsx` in Dropbox. One column with e-mail addresses, one with first names (for about half of them), one with the date they were added (since 2022).

How addresses get in:

- The sign-up form on the website sends me an e-mail ("New newsletter subscriber: ..."). I collect these and paste them into the sheet, usually on Wednesday.
- New customers: once a month I ask Lotte for the orders sheet and copy the new e-mail addresses over. Marieke says that is OK because they are customers.
- Business cards from events. I type them in.

How addresses get out: people reply to the newsletter with "unsubscribe" or "please remove me" or sometimes something less polite. Those replies arrive in my inbox between all the out-of-office replies (there are hundreds every week). I search for them on Wednesday and delete the rows. I am sure I miss some. We have had two angry mails this year from people who said they had unsubscribed three times. One of them mentioned GDPR.

There is no unsubscribe link. Outlook cannot do that.

### Writing and sending

1. I write the newsletter in Outlook: what is new this week (I ask Pieter), a tip, sometimes a discount. Writing takes about an hour and a half.
2. Our host allows maximum 100 recipients per e-mail. So I send the newsletter in **batches of 90 addresses in BCC**. 6,200 / 90 = about 69 e-mails. I copy 90 addresses from Excel, paste them in BCC, send, mark the rows in Excel so I know where I am, next.
3. The host also does not like it when you send too many mails in an hour, so I spread it over the afternoon. If I go too fast, the mails bounce and I do not know which batch arrived and which did not.

Sending takes about three hours, every Thursday. I do other things in between but I cannot leave.

Once, in batch 31, I pasted the addresses in CC instead of BCC. 90 people saw each other's e-mail addresses. We apologised.

What I do not know: how many people open it, what they click on, which addresses no longer exist. I see the bounce mails come in, but I do not have time to process them.

## Social media

We are on LinkedIn (company page and Marieke's personal profile, which works much better), X, Instagram and YouTube (short teasers).

When a new video is live, Tuesday and Friday:

1. I ask Pieter for the title and what it is about, or I watch the first minutes myself.
2. I write a post for LinkedIn. Then a shorter one for X. Then another one for Instagram with more hashtags and an image in a different size. For YouTube Pieter cuts a teaser of 40 seconds and I write the title and description.
3. I make the images in Canva: same template, different size per platform, change the title by hand.
4. I post everything by hand, on each platform separately. If the video goes live on Friday, when I am not working, I schedule what can be scheduled and Pieter posts the rest from my notes.

About an hour and a half per video, so three hours a week. The text is four times nearly the same, in four tones of voice.

I answer comments and questions under posts when I see them. Course ideas from comments should go on the whiteboard. They mostly do not.

## Thumbnails

Canva template. Per video: duplicate, change title, change episode number, change background colour per course, download as PNG, send to Pieter and Tom. Five minutes each, but it interrupts whatever I was doing.

## Discount actions

Three or four times a year (Black Friday, back to school, our birthday in May). A discount code does not exist in our system, because there is no system. People write "BLACKFRIDAY" in their order mail and Lotte and Marieke have to remember to apply it on the invoice. After last Black Friday, Marieke spent a full weekend on invoices.

## What I would love to know

- Which posts and newsletters actually lead to orders. Right now I have a feeling, not a number.
- Who of our customers is about to leave. Lotte has the end dates, I have the newsletter; we never put them together.

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 06

# Support and customer follow-up

*Internal handbook, chapter 6. Written by Lotte.*

## The support inbox

Customers mail `support@loopcasts.example`. It is a shared mailbox in Outlook. Pieter, Marieke and I all have it open. We get 60 to 80 mails a week, more after a newsletter.

The system is: whoever sees a mail first and knows the answer, answers it. We have no tickets and no "assigned to". So:

- Sometimes two of us answer the same customer, with slightly different answers.
- Sometimes everybody thinks somebody else will answer, and nobody does. I try to check every evening for mails older than two days. I flag them red.
- When a customer replies to an old thread from another mailbox, nobody sees the history.

We promise an answer within one working day. We make that most of the time, not on Thursdays (newsletter day, when also all the replies come in) and not when I am off.

## What people ask

I once counted for two weeks. Roughly:

| Question | Share | What I do |
|---|---|---|
| "I forgot my password" | 25% | See below. There is no "forgot password" link. |
| "I paid, where is my login?" | 15% | Check with Marieke whether the row is green. Usually they paid on Monday and it is Wednesday. |
| "Can I get a copy of my invoice?" / "Can you add our VAT number / PO number to the invoice?" | 15% | Find the PDF in Dropbox and mail it, or ask Marieke to redo the invoice. |
| "Video does not play" | 10% | Nearly always a company firewall blocking Vimeo, or an ad blocker. I have a standard text. |
| "Please change a seat in our team licence" | 5% | Change the e-mail in phpMyAdmin, new password, mail it. |
| "I want to cancel" / "Can I get a refund?" | 5% | Discuss with Marieke. We are generous, but it depends. |
| "In which video do you explain X?" | 10% | Ask Pieter. He usually knows. |
| "Is there a course about X coming?" | 5% | Should go on the whiteboard. |
| Everything else | 10% | Technical questions about a course go to Marieke. Partnerships, students asking for a discount, spam. |

For the top questions I have standard answers in a Word file, `support answers.docx`. I copy, paste and adapt. Marieke and Pieter do not use the file, they type from memory.

### Password reset

1. Log in to phpMyAdmin.
2. Find the customer in the `users` table (search by e-mail; if they mail from another address than the one they ordered with, that is a puzzle).
3. Type a new password, choose MD5 in the dropdown, save.
4. Mail the new password to the customer.

Five minutes, 15 to 20 times a week. I do not check whether the person who mails is really the customer. It never felt necessary.

## Renewals

Yearly subscriptions and team licences run for one year. There is no automatic renewal, because there is no automatic payment.

Around the first of each month:

1. I open the orders sheets of **last year** (`orders 2025.xlsx`) and filter on the month.
2. For every yearly customer of that month I send a mail: "your subscription ends on ..., would you like to renew?". I change the name and date by hand. About 80 to 100 mails a month, which takes most of a day.
3. If they answer yes, I add a new row in this year's orders sheet and it becomes a normal order (chapter 3).
4. If they do not answer, I should send a second mail two weeks later. I manage that about half of the time.
5. If they do not renew, I should set the account to inactive in phpMyAdmin.

Step 5 is the one that slips. I only do it when I have time, and I can only do it by going through the list and looking up each customer. Last summer Marieke asked me to check, and we found about 120 accounts that had ended months before and still worked. Some for more than a year. Some of those people were still watching every week. We did not dare to ask them for money afterwards.

Monthly subscribers are simpler and worse: they get an invoice every month (chapter 3). If they stop paying, it takes a while before anybody notices, because nobody compares the payments to the accounts.

## Team licences

A team licence has 5 seats. The customer mails the names. People leave companies, so the names change. I keep the list of who is in which team in the comment field of the Excel cell, because there was no column for it.

## What customers tell us

We get nice mails too, and good suggestions. They stay in the inbox. When Marieke asks "what do customers want?", I answer from my feeling of the last weeks.

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 07

# IT, backups and passwords

*Internal handbook, chapter 7. Written by Marieke, because nobody else wanted to. We have no IT person. Tom knows the most, Tom is here two days a week.*

## Passwords

All passwords are in `paswoorden.xlsx` in Dropbox, in the folder `ADMIN`. (Yes, with the Dutch spelling, I made that file in 2019.) It has the logins for the host, FTP, phpMyAdmin, Vimeo, Canva, the social media accounts, the Dropbox itself, and the bank card reader PIN, which should probably not be in there.

The file has no password, because then we would need a place to keep that password.

Rules:

- Everybody on the team has access to the file, because everybody needs something from it sooner or later.
- We use one shared login per service. There is one Vimeo account, one Canva account, one FTP user.
- When you change a password, update the file. If the file is wrong, try the previous one, it is probably still that.

The FTP password has not changed since 2019, because it is saved in FileZilla on five laptops and changing it means a morning of "it does not work any more".

## Who has access to what

Everybody has access to everything. It is simple and it has never been a problem.

Jens (our intern in 2019) still has his FTP login, I think, and he is still in the Dropbox. He once fixed a bug in the members area from Antwerp in 2021, which was very kind. We never removed him. Also still in the Dropbox: two freelancers who helped with editing in 2022, and my old private e-mail address.

## Laptops

Everybody has their own laptop; two people use their private one. Updates are your own responsibility. There is no disk encryption as far as I know. Yasmine's laptop was stolen from her car in 2023. Dropbox was on it, and she was logged in. We changed the Dropbox password that evening. We did not change the other passwords that were in the passwords file.

## Backups

- **Dropbox** is the backup of our files. If somebody deletes a folder by accident, it is gone for everybody, but Dropbox keeps deleted files for 30 days. We found that out the good way.
- **The website**: every Friday I download the whole site with FileZilla onto a USB drive. It takes about 40 minutes because of all the images. The USB drive is in my desk drawer. If I am recording or ill on Friday, it does not happen. I would say it happens two Fridays out of three.
- **The database** (the `users` table with all customer accounts): I should export it in phpMyAdmin every Friday as well. I often forget this one, because it is a separate step. The last export on the USB drive is from about six weeks ago.
- **The raw videos**: on Pieter's external disk and in Dropbox. Dropbox is nearly full, so Pieter deletes old raw files from Dropbox when it complains.
- **The mailboxes**: at the host. No backup of our own.

We have never tested whether we can actually put the website back from the USB drive.

## Customer data

We know where customer data lives, roughly:

- the orders sheets (name, e-mail, company, address, VAT number)
- the invoice register and all invoice Word and PDF files
- the `users` table (e-mail, MD5 password, end date)
- the newsletter list
- all our mailboxes: orders, support, and our personal ones, going back to 2019
- the conflicted copies and old versions of all of the above, in three `ADMIN` folders
- Marieke's old laptop, in the cupboard

A customer once asked us to delete all their data. We deleted the row in the orders sheet and the account. We could not delete the invoices (the accountant says we have to keep them seven years, that seems right). We did not think about the mailboxes and the newsletter list until later.

We do not have a register of processing activities or a written privacy procedure. Our privacy policy on the website is a template from 2019. Our accountant mentioned that we should "do something about GDPR" and we agreed.

## If something breaks

- Website down: call Tom. If it is not Tuesday or Thursday, call Tom anyway, he is nice about it. Then call the host.
- Members area down: call Tom, who will say he does not understand Jens' script either, and then he fixes it anyway.
- Mail down: the host.

- Laptop broken: the shop downstairs sells bikes, not laptops. There is a repair place around the corner.

Nobody gets a message when the website is down. We find out when a customer mails us, or when I try to show the site to somebody.

## AI tools

Several of us use ChatGPT for writing: Yasmine for posts, Pieter for descriptions, me for course outlines. Everybody uses their own free or private account. We have no agreement about what you may paste in there. Lotte once pasted a long customer complaint including the name and company to get help with a polite answer. It was a very good answer.